

Andre T. Parrish

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Cloud Systems Engineer

Cloud Platforms | Infrastructure as Code | Incident Response & Recovery | Security-Aware Operations

Collaborative infrastructure engineer with 30 years of stabilizing, recovering, and modernizing critical systems under pressure—from on-premises data centers to AWS and GCP cloud platforms. Proven track record of transforming legacy environments through Infrastructure as Code (Terraform, Puppet) and implementing robust CI/CD pipelines. Combines system administration roots with modern cloud architecture and security-aware operations to build self-healing systems.

Available for project-based and retainer engagements focused on stabilization, migration, and incident response.

Core Competencies

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, RDS, WAF, IAM, VPC), GCP (Compute Engine, Cloud SQL, GKE, Networking)

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, CloudFormation, Puppet, Ansible

Automation & DevOps: Jenkins, GitLab (repo management), Docker, Kubernetes, Python, Shell Scripting, Go

Security & Operations: DDoS Mitigation, Vulnerability Scanning, Incident Response, Network Security

System Reliability: Disaster Recovery, High Availability Architecture, Monitoring, Veritas Volume Manager

Professional Experience

Taos, an IBM Company | Remote *Infrastructure Specialist / Cloud Engineer* | Mar 2021 – Nov 2022

- Collaborated with a fellow consultant to migrate a major video streaming platform's AWS compute environments from Puppet 3.8 to 5.5, testing and validating ~270 production and third-party modules against release quality gates to ensure safe deployment transitions.
- Identified excessive errors in production logs, escalated the issue to staff engineers, and approved emergency rollback requests to resolve a critical deployment failure.
- Added missing metadata to 1st-party Puppet modules, bringing them closer to Puppet Forge standards; researched and recommended newer module versions via GitHub pull requests.
- Initiated progress discussions with client stakeholders and proactively researched module dependencies to identify unnecessary code for discontinuation.

Elsevier | New York, NY / Remote *Senior Cloud & Infrastructure Engineer* | Jun 2005 – Mar 2019

- Engineered infrastructure for AWS migration (2011 production release), building parallel backend environments (Oracle on EC2, multi-zone RDS) to ensure seamless cutover.

- Responded to production DDoS attack by architecting and automating a Layer 7 AWS WAF solution via custom Terraform module after existing CloudFlare measures failed.
- Led recovery efforts following Hurricane Sandy, navigating physical office closures to restore development and staging environments ahead of staff return.
- Developed self-service deployment pipelines using Jenkins Job DSL and Terraform, reducing manual intervention and deployment errors.
- Upgraded RAID storage to Veritas Volume Manager on production systems, reorganizing volume configurations to increase throughput and resiliency.

Elsevier | Hoboken, NJ *Senior System Administrator* | Apr 2002 – Jun 2005

- Managed critical infrastructure cooldown during summer blackout and cooling system failure, executing clean shutdown of remaining systems to protect assets with zero data loss.
- Configured servers for production mirror/DR site and developed scripts to replicate weekly data updates, ensuring business continuity.
- Administered core Unix/Solaris systems, DNS, UPS systems, and network backup infrastructure for development and staging data centers.

Earlier Career (Consulting & Financial Services) | 1993 – 2002

Provided crisis management, storage clustering, and security services for multiple clients including financial institutions, biotech firms, and media companies. Managed core systems, networking, and physical infrastructure for banking operations in international financial services.

Strategic Career Development & Independent Research | 2022 – Present

Completed intensive training in offensive and defensive security, earning CompTIA Security+ and Google Cybersecurity certifications. Engaged in bug bounty hunting via Intigriti and Bugcrowd, utilizing Burp Suite, OWASP Zap, and Kali Linux to identify vulnerabilities in live targets. Translated offensive security insights into defensive infrastructure design, focusing on proactive threat mitigation and attack surface reduction. Maintained technical proficiency through advanced coursework in cloud architecture and scripting (Pluralsight, TryHackMe containerized labs) while managing personal priorities.

Certifications

Active: Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate (2023), Security Engineer - TryHackMe (2024)

Currently: Pursuing renewal of AWS Solutions Architect - Associate certification (Target: Fall 2026)

Education

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Stevens Institute of Technology | Hoboken, NJ